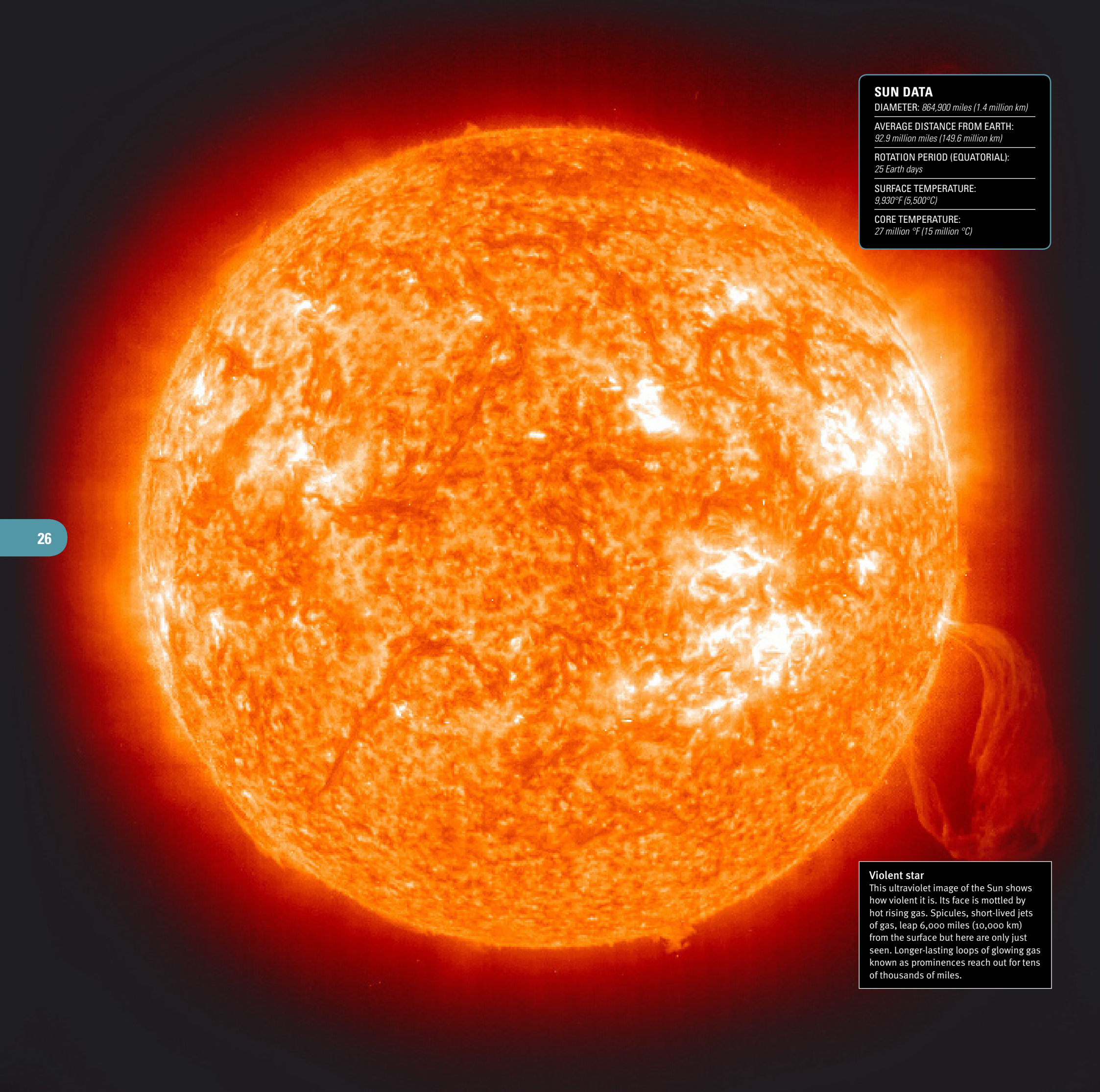




## SUN DATA

DIAMETER: 864,900 miles (1.4 million km)

AVERAGE DISTANCE FROM EARTH:  
92.9 million miles (149.6 million km)

ROTATION PERIOD (EQUATORIAL):  
25 Earth days

SURFACE TEMPERATURE:  
9,930°F (5,500°C)

CORE TEMPERATURE:  
27 million °F (15 million °C)

## Violent star

This ultraviolet image of the Sun shows how violent it is. Its face is mottled by hot rising gas. Spicules, short-lived jets of gas, leap 6,000 miles (10,000 km) from the surface but here are only just seen. Longer-lasting loops of glowing gas known as prominences reach out for tens of thousands of miles.